



03 – Platform Strategy

Each platform has ONE job. We don't post the same thing everywhere — we play each channel to its strength, all funneling to the owned audience (email + membership).

Platform roles at a glance

PLATFORM	PRIMARY JOB	FUNNEL STAGE	OWNED?
YouTube	Depth + discovery (the "home" of the show)	Awareness → Engagement	Rented
Instagram	Reach + personality (top of funnel)	Awareness	Rented
Substack	The owned audience + revenue	Engagement → Revenue	Owned
LinkedIn	Credibility + the influentials	Awareness → Trust	Rented
charlesblowshow.com	The hub everything points to	All stages	Owned

Golden rule: rented platforms create *demand*; owned platforms *capture and monetize* it. Every post has a path to email signup.

YouTube – the home base

Job: Host the long-form conversations; be the searchable, evergreen library; primary discovery via search + suggested.

Content:

- **Daily spine:** 🌞 *Lunch Break Live* (10 min, live) + 🌙 *The Evening Show* (20 min, guest) — Mon–Fri. The live segment is great for live watch-time and the algorithm; the Evening Show builds the evergreen library.
- **Monthly tentpoles:** *Big Interview*, *State of the Unions*, *Roundtable*.
- **Shorts:** 6+ per day across both segments, hooks in first 2 seconds, captioned, vertical.
- **Live:** daily *Lunch Break Live*, monthly Town Hall, election-night & breaking-news specials.

Optimization:

- Thumbnails: high-contrast, Blow's face + guest + a tension-carrying phrase.
- Titles: curiosity + clarity (the question the episode answers).
- Chapters on every long-form video; pinned comment with the "What Now?" action + newsletter link.
- Playlists by segment franchise ("The Throughline," guest series).

Cadence: 2 segments/day (Mon–Fri), 6+ Shorts/day, monthly tentpoles + Town Hall live.

KPIs: watch-time hours, avg view duration / % completion, **subscriber growth toward the 10k monetization gate**, Shorts → long-form conversion, **clicks to newsletter from cards/description**.

Instagram – reach & personality

Job: Widen the top of funnel; humanize Blow; convert scrollers into subscribers.

Content:

- **Reels:** *Blow's Brief*, best guest clips, "The Throughline" micro-explainers.
- **Carousels:** the week's argument in 6 slides; "Reading List"; quote sets.
- **Stories:** behind-the-scenes, polls/questions (community + research), episode countdowns, link stickers to site/Substack.
- **Broadcast Channel:** drop-link alerts to most-engaged fans.

Optimization: strong first-frame hook, baked-in captions, consistent visual template, trend-aware audio *only when on-brand*. Link in bio → site landing → email capture.

Cadence: 1 Reel/day (batched), 3–5 Stories/day, 2 carousels/week.

KPIs: reach, shares & saves (the real signals), follower growth, profile → link taps, link-tap → subscribe rate.

Substack – the owned audience & revenue engine

Job: This is the *product's balance sheet*. Convert attention into an email relationship and recurring revenue.

Structure:

- **Free tier:** weekly column + newsletter → reach & list growth.

- **Paid tier (\$6–8/mo or ~\$60/yr):** full archive, subscriber-only posts, ad-free podcast feed, monthly Town Hall access, comment community, Mailbag priority.
- **Founding member:** premium tier (events, annual call, recognition).

Content: the weekly Column, episode companion pieces, hot-take Notes, monthly long read, the weekly Newsletter digest. Use **Notes** as Substack's native social layer to recruit free subs.

Optimization: every episode and clip CTAs to subscribe; welcome sequence for new subs; periodic "free post that should be paid" to demonstrate value; paywall the back half of select deep pieces.

Cadence: 1 column + 1 newsletter/week, 2–4 Notes/week, 1 long read/month.

KPIs: total subscribers (north star), paid conversion %, MRR/churn, open & click rates, reply rate.

LinkedIn – credibility & the influentials

Job: Reach operatives, journalists, academics, nonprofit/policy leaders — the people who *amplify and cite*. Also a B2B/sponsor & speaking-gig surface.

Content:

- Text-first essays (excerpts of the column reframed for a professional audience).
- Native-uploaded clips with a sharp written framing on top.
- "What this means for [civic life / institutions / democracy]" angle — substance over snark.
- Document/PDF carousels of the Reading List or key arguments.

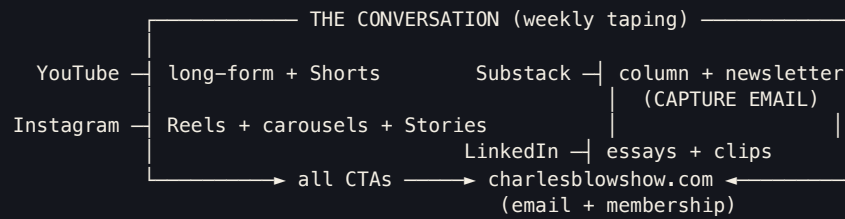
Optimization: hook in first 2 lines (before "see more"), native video, post in professional-hours windows, engage in comments (LinkedIn rewards author replies). No engagement-bait.

Cadence: 3–4 posts/week.

KPIs: impressions among target titles, profile follows, comment quality, referral traffic to site/Substack, inbound (sponsor/speaking).

Cross-platform operating model

Single editorial calendar governs everything. One theme per week flows across all channels in formats native to each.



Adaptation, not duplication: the same idea is a YouTube title, an IG hook, a LinkedIn thesis, and a Substack argument — phrased for each audience.

Consistency system: shared brand kit (logo, color, type, lower-thirds, templates) so the show is instantly recognizable in any feed.